

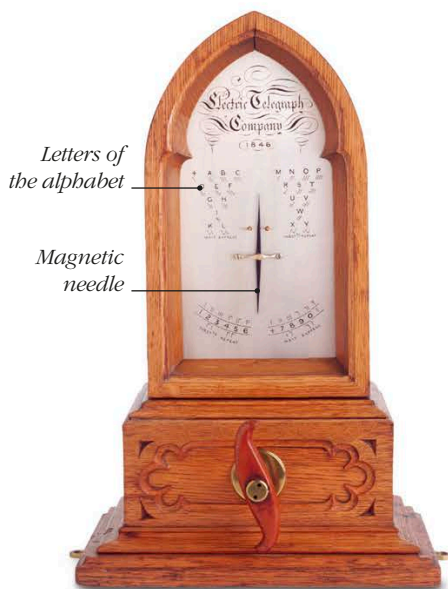
Electric telegraph

Cooke and Wheatstone telegraph

Where England

When 1837

The world's first commercial electric telegraph was designed by British inventors William Cooke and Charles Wheatstone. Electric signals sent along a wire moved a needle to point to letters on a grid, which spelled out the message to the receiver.



Steel furnace

Bessemer furnace

Where England

When 1856

English inventor Henry Bessemer's furnace greatly sped up the process of turning molten iron into steel, which was stronger and longer-lasting than iron. Steel was used to make railroads and ships, and soon the first steel-framed buildings began to appear on city skylines.



1750-1900

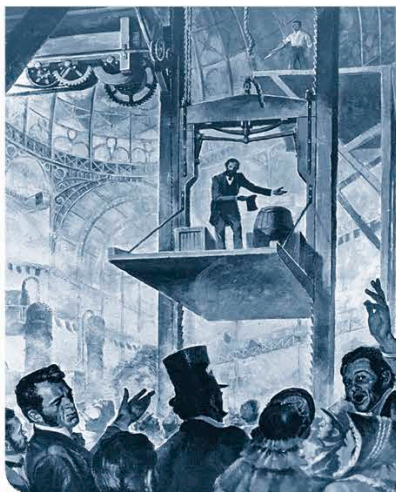
Safe elevator

Passenger hydraulic elevator

Where US

When 1857

Fitted with a device that would stop it tumbling even if the cable broke, the first safety elevator was installed by US engineer Elisha Otis in a New York City department store. As elevators could now carry passengers quickly to previously impossible heights, skyscrapers began to be built to save space in busy cities.



Cooling system

Portable refrigeration system

Where Germany

When 1873

The first modern refrigeration system was designed by German scientist Carl Von Linde for a brewery in the city of Munich. His invention soon became an essential part of the food and drink industry, allowing easily spoiled goods to be stored and transported safely.



First automobile

Benz Patent-Motorwagen

Where Germany

When 1885

The first car to be powered by an internal combustion engine was designed by German engineer Karl Benz. In 1888, his wife Bertha drove their two sons on a 75-mile (120-km) trip in the Benz Patent-Motorwagen. News of the journey's success quickly spread and automobile sales took off.

